

Studio 3

Discover

Developer Architecture Document

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Studio 3 · Dallas, TX

1. Overview

Studio 3 Discover is the social discovery arm of the Studio 3 platform. It functions as a curated, process-forward social app where artists share work, viewers discover art, and collectors find and purchase original pieces. Discover is one of three arms of the Studio 3 ecosystem — alongside Studio 3 Marketplace (creative supply marketplace) and Studio 3 (the physical studio space app). All three arms share a single Studio 3 account.

This document covers the full feature set, logic, and flow of Studio 3 Discover as defined in the product architecture phase. It is intended to inform the development team prior to UI build.

2. Ecosystem & App Architecture

2.1 The Three Arms

- Studio 3 Discover — Social discovery, posting, artist profiles, commerce layer
- Studio 3 Marketplace — Creative supply marketplace connecting users to local retailers
- Studio 3 (Physical) — Studio space app for bookings, events, membership management

All three arms share one Studio 3 account. The model follows Adobe Creative Cloud — one account logs you into each arm. Each arm has its own contained experience. Users navigate between arms via an app switcher accessible from the bottom navigation bar in each app.

2.2 App Switcher

The app switcher is accessible via a persistent icon in the bottom navigation bar — the Studio 3 three-circle mark. Tapping it opens an overlay showing the three arms. The icon sits at the far left of the bottom nav bar.

3. Navigation

3.1 Bottom Navigation Bar

Six elements in the following order, left to right:

- Studio 3 mark (app switcher icon) — far left
- For You tab
- Explore tab
- Post button — centered, visually elevated from the tab row
- Saved tab
- Profile tab — far right

3.2 Top Bar

- Notifications icon — opens the Activity + Messages panel
 - Search bar (Explore only) — persistent at top of Explore tab
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4. For You Tab

4.1 Purpose

For You is a personalized, curated discovery feed. It is not an infinite scroll feed. Each session has a finite number of posts. The feed refreshes with new content, giving users a reason to return rather than chasing the bottom of an endless feed.

4.2 Feed Composition

- Blended feed — posts from accounts the user follows mixed with algorithmically surfaced work
- Finite per session — session ends, user sees a completion state, feed refreshes
- No infinite scroll
- Following toggle — available within the tab, not a separate tab, allowing users to view only content from accounts they follow

4.3 Grid Layout

Two-column editorial grid. Two tile format options: Portrait and Landscape. Artists select their format in the posting flow and see a live preview before publishing.

- Portrait 1 col — base unit, tall and narrow. Always paired side by side. Target: 30% of portrait tiles in a session.
- Full width — spans both columns, maximum presence. The dominant tile type. Target: 50% of portrait tiles in a session.
- Landscape — spans both columns, shorter and wider. Auto-assigned to square and landscape uploads. Target: 20% of portrait tiles in a session.
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Artists select Portrait, Full Width, or Landscape in the posting flow. A live preview shows exactly how the tile and crop will appear before posting. Artists adjust the crop within their chosen format. The profile renders at whatever format the artist selected.

TILE FORMAT SELECTION AND PREVIEW

Two tile format options in the posting flow: Portrait (tall, narrow — shows as full width on the artist's own profile) and Landscape (spans both columns, shorter and wider). Artist selects their preferred format, adjusts the crop within that format, and sees a live preview before posting.

4.4 Personalization — Taste Profile

The taste profile is built from three input layers:

- Initial signal — this-or-that onboarding taste selection (5 rounds)
- Behavioral signal — saves, time spent on a piece, mediums returned to, artists followed after discovery, content skipped
- Manual signal — user-adjustable taste profile settings within the app

The algorithm weights taste match as the dominant signal for content surfacing. Engagement velocity (how quickly a post is gaining platform-wide engagement) is a secondary signal weighted lightly to avoid recreating performance-driven dynamics.

4.5 Curated Moments

Curated moments interrupt the feed at approximately 20% of total session tiles. They are personalized — based on the individual user's taste profile rather than platform-wide editorial decisions. Types include:

- Weekly edit — a finite collection curated for that user based on their taste profile that week
- Because you saved X — surfaces work related to a recently saved piece
- Artists you might follow — based on following patterns and taste profile
- Revisit — work saved or engaged with previously, resurfaced
- Medium deep dive — if strong affinity for a medium is detected, a curated collection going deeper

Curated moments share the 20-25% interruption budget with ads and sponsored content. No interruption of any kind appears in the first four tiles of a session.

4.6 Ads & Sponsored Content

Ads, sponsored posts, and art events share the same 20-25% interruption budget as curated moments. Placement priority within this budget is determined by what has been purchased, not editorial judgment. Interruptions are never placed back-to-back — a minimum of several art tiles must appear between any two interruptions.

4.7 New User State

Before enough taste data has accumulated, For You functions as an Explore-like experience — broadly curated rather than tightly personalized. A subtle 'Building your feed' label appears at the top of the tab during this phase. It disappears once the taste profile has sufficient data. This ensures new users always have meaningful content to interact with from day one.

5. Explore Tab

5.1 Purpose

Explore is the open browsing experience of Discover. It surfaces the full Studio 3 world — art posts, for sale work, events, and learn content — in a mixed infinite scroll grid. Unlike For You, Explore is not tightly personalized. It is lightly informed by the user's taste profile but intentionally broader, designed to surface work outside the user's established preferences.

5.2 Page Structure (top to bottom)

- Search bar — persistent, always visible at top
- Filter bar — horizontal scrolling pills (see 5.4)
- Featured moment — full width editorial card, changes regularly (see 5.3)
- Masonry grid — infinite scroll, two columns (see 5.5)

5.3 Featured Moment

A full-width editorial card that opens the Explore grid. It represents Studio 3's editorial voice — a human-curated statement about what matters on the platform right now. It is the same for all users (not personalized). It rotates regularly and can feature:

- A featured artist
- A thematic collection
- A learn moment
- A trending cultural moment on the platform
- A spotlight on a local artist

The featured moment should be evaluated against this standard: would this work as a magazine cover?

5.4 Filter Bar

A horizontally scrollable row of filter pills. Two mode-level pills appear first:

- For Sale — narrows grid to available for sale work only (excludes sold pieces)
- Events — narrows grid to events only; triggers a dropdown filter row below (Date, Location, Event type) rather than updating the pill row

Then category pills:

- Painting, Photography, Sculpture, Digital, Textile, Installation, Mixed Media

Tapping a category pill activates it and updates the pill row to show style filters relevant to that medium (e.g. Painting reveals Abstract, Figurative, Expressionist, Minimalist, Realist). Tapping the active category pill again returns to the top-level category list.

Multiple pills can be active simultaneously. Search and filters work together — a keyword search with active filter pills narrows to that intersection.

5.5 Masonry Grid

Two-column masonry layout. Tiles flow at their natural image aspect ratio — portrait images create tall tiles, landscape images create shorter wider tiles. No fixed tile sizes; the image content determines the tile shape. Gap: 16px vertical, 4% horizontal gutter.

Editorial interrupts appear as tiles within the masonry flow — visually distinct from art tiles but same width. They draw from the 20-25% interruption budget. Three sources of editorial interrupt content: (1) Studio 3 produced — fully designed editorial, featured artists, thematic collections, learn moments. Landscape format. (2) Artist POV learn content — artist-produced learning posts tagged as such, flow at natural aspect ratio in the masonry. (3) Algorithmically elevated artist posts — regular uploads identified as high momentum or high taste match for a specific user, pulled out of the standard grid and surfaced as an editorial interrupt with a callout treatment. Visual callout design TBD in UI build.

5.6 Search

A persistent search bar above the filter pills. When a user searches:

- Up to 5 artist results appear in a horizontal strip at the top of results
- Post results appear in the masonry grid below

Toggle options within search results:

- All (default)

- Artists
- Posts
- Events
- Learn

5.7 Empty States

All empty states follow two principles: always provide something to interact with, and always offer a clear next step action. Empty states never dead-end. Examples:

- Filter + no results: 'No sculptures for sale yet. Explore all sculpture — or browse what's available.' with tappable actions
- Search + no results: suggest broader search terms as tappable pills, offer 'Explore everything'
- Events filter + no results in area: 'No events near you right now. Check back soon — or explore events everywhere.'

6. Posting Flow

6.1 Post Button

Centered in the bottom nav bar, visually elevated. Identical for all users. The seller-specific post type selection only appears for users who have activated a seller profile.

6.2 Media Types at Launch

- Image
- Video
- Carousel (multiple images/videos)

For carousel posts, the artist must designate a hero image. The hero image is what appears in the feed, carries the for sale indicator if applicable, and serves as the primary reference for the authentication process on for sale posts.

6.3 Post Type Selection

For seller profile users only. Appears early in the post flow, after media selection, because the field set differs:

- Social post — standard sharing
- For sale post — commerce layer activated

6.4 Standard Social Post — Fields

- Artist intent — the artist's caption, framed as what they were thinking/exploring (not a generic caption field)
- Medium — structured selection
- Materials used — free entry, links to Studio 3 Marketplace where matches exist
- Style/category — optional, multi-select
- Process toggle — indicates this post is process/WIP content rather than a finished work; allows linking to related process videos
- Series tag — allows linking to a related series of posts
- AI disclosure toggle — required if AI tools were used in creation; displays a visible indicator on the published post
- Alt text — artist-provided description for accessibility; if not provided, AI generates and auto-applies (labeled as AI-generated)

6.5 For Sale Post — Additional Fields

Inherits all standard post fields plus:

- Price
- Dimensions
- Framing/mounting status
- Edition type — one of a kind, limited edition, open edition
- Year created
- Certificate of authenticity confirmation
- Location of work — for Studio 3 authentication pickup/logistics coordination
- Provenance notes — exhibition history, prior sales, publications (optional)
- Handling notes — fragility, special care instructions for authentication process

6.6 Publishing Logic

STANDARD SOCIAL POSTS

Go live immediately upon submission. Background review runs post-publish. If a post fails review it is taken down with a notification to the artist explaining why.

FOR SALE POSTS

Held in a pending state. Must pass Studio 3 Verified review before going live. Artist receives notification when cleared.

6.7 Post Review — What Is Checked

- Is this actually art — human review for edge cases, automated flagging for obviously off-topic content
- AI generated without disclosure — AI detection flags undisclosed AI content for human review
- Stolen/plagiarized work — reverse image search as first automated layer, human review for flagged results

Review approach: automated first pass catches obvious violations instantly. Human review handles edge cases, disclosure conflicts, and a random sample of passing posts for quality maintenance.

6.8 Filters

No stylistic filters permitted on any post type. Basic adjustments allowed (brightness, contrast, crop) that serve accurate representation of the work. For sale posts: no filters of any kind. Accurate color and condition representation is required for the Studio 3 Verified standard.

6.9 Post States

A post can exist in three states visible to viewers:

- Social post — no indicator
- For sale — green dot indicator; tapping reveals price and purchase details
- Sold — subtle sold indicator; work remains visible unless artist archives it

Sold works continue to surface in For You and Explore algorithmically, treated as editorial/social proof content. They are excluded from For Sale filter results.

ALGORITHM BEHAVIOR FOR SOLD WORKS

When a work sells, commercial weighting drops and the post is treated as engagement content. A short algorithmic boost is applied immediately after the sold moment (peak social interest window), then settles into normal circulation.

7. Studio 3 Verified

7.1 What It Is

Studio 3 Verified is a platform mark applied to for sale listings confirming that Studio 3 has reviewed and cleared the work prior to publication. It appears on every for sale post. It is not optional — all for sale work must pass verification before going live.

7.2 V1 Process — Digital Verification

At launch, verification is digital. As part of seller profile setup, artists complete a structured submission that includes:

- High resolution documentation of the work
- Provenance statement
- Process record
- Signed certificate of authenticity

Studio 3 reviews and approves the submission before the listing goes live. The mark reads 'Studio 3 Verified' — no public explanation of the verification mechanics. The brand carries the trust signal.

V2 will move toward physical authentication — Studio 3 receives the work, physically inspects and documents it, then fulfills to the buyer. The Verified mark remains consistent across both versions; the rigor behind it deepens over time.

7.3 Logistics

Studio 3 handles all shipping and delivery logistics. Artists do not manage fulfillment. Location of work is collected at post time to coordinate authentication pickup or shipping from the artist.

8. Artist Profiles

8.1 Purpose

A profile functions as a portfolio with personality. The work leads, the person behind it gives context. It is not a social media profile — it is a curated representation of an artist's practice.

8.2 Profile Structure (top to bottom)

- Magnum opus banner — full width, artist-selected hero piece
- Overlay on banner — artist name, profile image, style/medium, location, commission availability indicator (v2)
- Bio — below the banner, character-limited
- Metrics row — pieces sold, total saves (no follower count publicly visible)
- Tabs — Work, Process, For Sale

8.3 Magnum Opus Banner

The artist selects their banner from three options in profile settings:

- Manual — artist picks a specific post as the banner
- Auto-update — artist selects the criteria: most saved piece or most recent piece
- None — no banner; profile renders in a different default layout

8.4 Work Tab

Displays all posts — social, for sale, and sold — in a masonry grid. Sold and for sale pieces carry their respective indicators.

SERIES GROUPING

Off by default. Artist can enable in profile settings. When enabled, series are grouped at the top of the grid ordered by most recent series first. Within each series, posts are ordered chronologically. The artist can toggle this preference on or off at any time.

SORT ORDER

Default: most recent first. Artist can change in profile settings to oldest first or most saved.

8.5 Process Tab

Displays posts tagged as process content only. Same masonry grid.

8.6 For Sale Tab

Displays active for sale listings only. Excludes sold work. Same masonry grid.

8.7 Seller Profile

Self-service activation. Artists who activate a seller profile unlock:

- For sale post type in the posting flow
- Work Inquiries tier in their inbox
- Full professional analytics dashboard
- Studio 3 Verified process for their listings

Seller profile setup collects payment details, location, and triggers the Studio 3 Verified submission flow.

8.8 Commission Toggle (V2)

Commissions are excluded from V1. The toggle lives on the profile as a signal in V2 with a full structured commission request flow, production status mechanic, revision process, and payment release on delivery.

9. Onboarding

9.1 Flow

Three steps:

- Step 1 — Account creation (name, email, password, optional profile photo)
- Step 2 — Intention questions (three screens, one question each)
- Step 3 — This-or-that taste selection (five rounds)
- Result screen — brief taste profile summary with 'this will evolve' messaging, then into the app

9.2 Intention Questions

Three sequential screens, one question per screen. Progress dots shown. Back navigation available. Each question has three response options. Users can answer all three questions regardless of how they answered previous ones — these are not mutually exclusive.

- Question 1 (Artist): 'Do you create and share your own work?' — All the time, Sometimes, Not really
- Question 2 (Collector): 'Do you invest in or purchase original art?' — Actively, Occasionally, Not yet
- Question 3 (Enthusiast): 'How deeply do you follow the creative world?' — Very, Somewhat, Just getting into it

ALGORITHM SEEDING BASED ON INTENTION ANSWERS

Heavy artist response: For You seeds with peer work, process content, what artists in similar mediums are making.

Heavy collector response: For You seeds with for sale work, Studio 3 Verified pieces, artists with strong save and sold signals.

Heavy enthusiast response: For You seeds with a balanced mix of process content, finished work, editorial moments.

Mixed responses: algorithm weights proportionally across the three content directions.

Collector data is also used to inform verified collector status behind the scenes. Verified collector status is not publicly visible in V1 but surfaces in artist analytics dashboards as an intelligence signal.

9.3 This-or-That Taste Selection

Five rounds of paired image comparisons. User picks one image from each pair. Skippable. Each selection builds the aesthetic taste profile. After completion, a brief result screen shows the user's taste profile summary with messaging that it will evolve as they engage. Users can adjust their taste profile manually in settings at any time.

10. Algorithm & Personalization

10.1 Taste Profile Inputs

- Onboarding intention answers — broad content direction weighting
- This-or-that aesthetic selections — aesthetic preference signals
- Save behavior — strongest behavioral signal
- Time spent on a piece
- Mediums returned to repeatedly

- Artists followed after discovery vs. already known
- Content skipped or scrolled past quickly
- Manual taste profile adjustments

10.2 For You Algorithm Signals

Dominant signal: taste match strength between post and user's taste profile.

Secondary signals: artist relationship (followed vs. discovered), recency, engagement velocity (weighted lightly to avoid performance-driven dynamics).

10.3 Tile Size Adaptation

No artist tile selection exists. Tile format selection and preview automatically. The algorithm decides full width vs 1 col for portrait tiles on the viewer's For You feed based on taste match strength, artist relationship, recency, and post type. Target distribution: full width 50%, portrait 1 col pairs 30%, landscape 20%. Landscape tiles are self-selecting and excluded from the portrait distribution calculation.

10.4 Sold Work Algorithm Behavior

When a work sells: commercial weighting drops, post treated as engagement/editorial content. Short algorithmic boost applied immediately post-sale (peak social interest window). Excluded from For Sale filter results only. Continues to surface normally everywhere else.

10.5 Explore Algorithm

Broader than For You. Lightly informed by taste profile but intentionally surfaces work outside established preferences. Primarily driven by platform-wide signals: recency, engagement, editorial curation.

11. Social Signals & Engagement

11.1 Post-Level Signals

- Save — primary public engagement signal, count visible
- Comments — count visible, tappable to open thread
- Share — action only, no count

No likes. No like count. Ever in V1. Studio 3 does not display like counts because a number does not define the value of work.

11.2 Follow

Follow button accessible directly from any post view (adjacent to artist name and profile image) and from the artist's profile. Following an artist surfaces their work in the Following toggle within For You.

11.3 Post View

Tapping a tile opens a full-screen post view. Default state: image fills majority of screen, not fully edge-to-edge. Info panel visible below without scrolling. Tapping the image enters true full-screen mode (edge-to-edge, no UI). Tapping again returns to default view.

POST VIEW LAYOUT (TOP TO BOTTOM)

- Top left: artist profile image and name (tappable to profile)
- Image — majority of screen
- Follow button — adjacent to artist name
- Save, comments, share — immediately below image
- Artist intent — breadcrumb cut off after 1-2 lines, tap to expand
- Expanded: medium, materials, process link, series link, for sale details (price + purchase CTA)

12. Saved Tab

12.1 Structure

- All collection — default, always exists, cannot be deleted, every saved piece appears here
- User collections — named collections created by the user

A piece can be saved to multiple collections simultaneously. It always appears in All regardless of which collections it is added to.

12.2 Privacy

All collections are private by default. Users can make individual collections public (V2 feature). Public collections are a planned editorial interrupt type in Explore — a well-curated public collection from a respected community member surfaces as a featured moment.

12.3 Display

Same two-column masonry grid as Explore.

13. Commerce & Transactions

13.1 For Sale Indicator

Three post states visible to viewers:

- Social post — no indicator
- For sale — green dot; tapping reveals price, dimensions, edition, and purchase CTA
- Sold — subtle sold indicator; work remains in feed unless artist archives

The green dot uses a secondary visual indicator in addition to color (shape or label) to meet accessibility standards for colorblind users.

13.2 Transaction Flow

All transactions route through Studio 3. No external payment links. Studio 3 handles:

- Payment processing
- Authentication (Studio 3 Verified)
- Logistics and delivery
- Certificate of authenticity

Revenue model: transaction fees on artist sales + sponsored content/ads.

13.3 Commissions (V2)

Excluded from V1. No commission indicator on profiles in V1. Full commission flow in V2 includes: structured request form, negotiation/counter flow, agreement lock, production status updates, buyer review and approval, and payment release on delivery. All transactions route through Studio 3.

14. Messaging & Notifications

14.1 Access Point

Notifications icon in the top bar. Opens a panel with two tabs: Activity and Messages.

14.2 Messages

ENTRY POINTS

- Work inquiry — initiated from a specific post (tap 'Message about this work'). Thread is anchored to the specific piece, which displays at the top of the conversation.
- Direct message — initiated from an artist's profile. Open conversation, not anchored to a specific work.

All conversations route to the same unified inbox regardless of entry point. Context of initiation is visible within the thread.

INBOX TIERS

For seller profile users — three tiers:

- Work Inquiries — any message initiated from a post, regardless of sender. Always primary.
- General — messages initiated from a profile. People the user follows surface higher; unknown accounts surface lower.
- Filtered — low quality, suspicious, contextless messages.

For non-seller profile users — two tiers: General and Filtered. No Work Inquiries tier.

MESSAGE PERMISSIONS

Artists can set message preferences in profile settings: open to everyone, followers only, or nobody.

14.3 Activity (Notifications)

NEVER BATCHED — ALWAYS REAL TIME

- New messages
- Sales
- Work inquiries

BATCHED — DAILY DIGEST

- Saves
- Follows
- Comments
- New work from artists you follow

Daily digest timing is user-configurable in notification settings. Push notifications follow the same batching logic — one daily digest push for engagement activity, immediate push for real-time events. Users can toggle individual notification types on or off.

15. Content Moderation

15.1 Reporting Flow

Report action accessible from any post via a tap menu. Report reasons:

- Not art
- AI generated without disclosure
- Stolen/plagiarized work
- Inappropriate content
- Spam

Single reports enter a moderation queue. Posts that receive multiple reports are automatically hidden pending review (threshold-based, not single-report removal). Serious violations (stolen work, child safety) trigger immediate removal.

Reporter receives a notification when their report has been reviewed and action taken.

Three strikes on warnings leads to account suspension.

15.2 Content Standard

ABSOLUTE NOS — NO ARTISTIC DEFENSE

- Explicit sexual content
- Any content involving minors
- Hate speech or discriminatory content
- Targeted harassment
- Stolen or plagiarized work
- Undisclosed AI-generated content

ARTISTIC INTENT STANDARD — CASE BY CASE HUMAN REVIEW

Nudity, violence, dark themes, provocative imagery, and politically charged work are evaluated against the question: does this exist within a legitimate artistic tradition or context? The artist intent field is evidence in this determination. Studio 3's moderation team requires arts literacy to apply this standard consistently.

15.3 Block & Mute

BLOCK

Complete severance. Blocked user cannot see your content, cannot message you, cannot purchase your work, and is removed from your followers. Works bidirectionally — neither party can transact with the other. Blocking is silent to the blocked user.

MUTE

Soft action. You stop seeing their content in your feed. They can still see yours, follow you, and comment. No transaction impact. Mute is silent to the muted user.

Both accessible via long press or three-dot menu on any post or profile.

16. Artist Analytics

16.1 All Artists — Creative Insights

- Total saves
- Saves per post
- Profile views
- Post reach
- Follower growth
- Medium and series resonance — which mediums/series generate the most engagement
- Process vs. finished work performance — does process content drive more follows/profile visits than finished work

16.2 Seller Profile — Professional Dashboard

All creative insights plus:

FINANCIAL

- Total revenue
- Revenue by period
- Sales history
- Average sale price
- Payout history and pending payouts

COLLECTOR INTELLIGENCE

- Verified collector saves — which pieces verified collectors have saved
- Collector attention signals — early signal that serious buyers are paying attention
- Demand forecasting — pieces with high save velocity from collector-type accounts that haven't sold, signaling pricing or visibility opportunity
- Work inquiry volume
- Inquiry to sale conversion rate

DISCOVERY INSIGHTS

- Discovery source breakdown — how people are finding your work (For You, Explore, search, share, collection)
- Series momentum — does engagement build across a series or drop off

CONTEXTUAL INTELLIGENCE

- Taste affinity mapping — which aesthetic profiles your work resonates with most

- Anonymous peer benchmarking — how your engagement metrics compare to artists in similar mediums (percentage-based, no names)
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17. Accessibility

17.1 Non-Negotiables from Day One

- Color contrast — all UI elements meet WCAG AA minimum contrast ratios
- Tap target sizes — minimum 44x44px for all interactive elements
- For sale green dot — must use a secondary indicator (shape or label) in addition to color; color alone is insufficient for colorblind users
- Consistent navigation patterns — no unexpected UI changes between sessions

17.2 Alt Text

Artist-provided alt text is the preferred default. The posting flow frames this as: 'Describe this work for those who can't see it.' If the artist does not provide alt text, AI analyzes the image and auto-generates a description. AI-generated alt text is labeled as such so screen reader users understand the source.

18. Parked for V2

The following features are defined in the architecture but excluded from V1:

- Commissions — full request, negotiation, production, and delivery flow
 - Artist verification — public facing; impersonation handled quietly through account/seller profile setup in V1
 - Public collections — user collections can be made public and surfaced as editorial interrupts
 - Location filter — geographic filtering of posts by artist location
 - Like counts — possible future consideration; no likes in V1
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19. Platform Naming

- Studio 3 Discover — this app
- Studio 3 Marketplace — creative supply marketplace
- Studio 3 — the physical studio space app

The name 'Discover' is a placeholder. A permanent name for this arm is TBD.

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